



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	062	Author:	L Hardy	Date:	18.10.2023
Topic:	Alcohol and Drugs				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

This talk will cover the effects of alcohol and drugs on your safety and that of others.

Drugs

- 1 You are far more likely to have an accident on site when you are under the influence of drugs.
- 2 Drugs prescribed by your doctor could make you unfit for work, as can illegal drugs.
- 3 You may feel you don't have a drug problem – it's got nothing to do with you. But if you get hurt, it's a bit late to wonder what the other person was on.
- 4 If you know somebody is on drugs, tell your supervisor – help to stamp it out.
- 5 Signs to look for, watery eyes, pinpoint or dilated pupils, running nose, constant sniffing, tight lips, sores, ulcers, trembling, fatigue and irritability. If you see it, report it.
- 6 All drugs can affect your ability to work safely.
- 7 Some effects of drugs: slow reaction times, clumsiness, poor decision-making and distorted vision.
- 8 Don't take 'E's – 'E' stands for 'Ex-employee'.
- 9 If you get offered drugs, say no, you'd rather work safely!
- 10 Drugs and work don't mix. Don't let it become a problem.

Alcohol

- 1 In a high-risk industry like ours, alcohol and work are not compatible.
- 2 Alcohol is a depressant drug, which depresses parts of the brain function. When working on site you require all of your brain functions to save you from injury.
- 3 If you're found to be intoxicated with drink, you won't be allowed on site. You may end up losing your job.
- 4 Don't get drunk the night before and expect to work safely on site the next day. Alcohol takes time to work out of your system (1 pint of beer takes approximately 2 hours).
- 5 50% of all drivers killed are over the legal limit.
- 6 If you drink, don't drive.
- 7 Some workplace fatal accidents are alcohol related.
- 8 Keep your head clear – leave your drinking sessions to social events, where you can't cause injury to yourself or others.
- 9 Get a bad reputation for drinking and you may not get another job as you'll be seen as a liability.

**REMEMBER**

Drugs and Alcohol have a serious effect on your capability to work safely and as such we have a zero tolerance in place. However as a company, the welfare of our employees is a major consideration and we would be able to assist any employee that has a drink and drugs problem or a personal issue that you feel you would need to talk about. You can approach our HR team in the strictest of confidence.

Additionally, the company Drug & Alcohol Abuse policy states “ *we reserve the right to require you to undergo a medical examination or to submit to a test for substances/drugs/alcohol and to search the Company’s premises as well as objects and persons on the Company’s premises, for evidence of any breaches of this policy. If you refuse to undergo a medical examination, your refusal may constitute gross misconduct under the Company’s disciplinary procedure. The Company reserves the right to perform any test itself and is not required to involve a medical practitioner*”

Discussion Points

What would you do if you suspected a colleague was working whilst under the influence of Drugs or Alcohol?

Why do you think someone would come to work if they were under the influence?